Study Guide

In the style of Edexcel and OCR

How far do you agree that Palestinian terrorism was the *main* reason for the failure to establish lasting peace between Israel and the Palestinians from 1973 to 2003?

Exam tips

The cross-references are intended to take you straight to the material that will help you to answer the question.

Re-read Chapters 5 and 6.

In this essay you have to analyse the effects of Palestinian terrorism, as well as other obstacles to lasting peace, before making a judgement on whether terrorism was the *main* factor. It is probably best to focus first on the obstacles to peace *before* the signing of the Oslo Accords in 1993 and *then* on the difficulties/issues that were specific to the period after 1993.

On the earlier period, covered in Chapter 5, you should assess the influence of:

- Palestinian opposition to the state of Israel and frequent resort to violence (although this will need to be qualified, e.g. Arafat at the UN in 1974) (page 92)
- cross-border raids on Israel by PLO and Israeli reprisals (including invasion of Lebanon)
- international terrorism in the 1970s, e.g. hijackings and murders at the Olympics.

Equally, you need to assess the degree of Israel's responsibility:

- Israel's occupation of all or most of Gaza and the West Bank and its unwillingness to recognise the PLO
- building of Jewish settlements in the occupied territories
- Israeli military rule in the occupied territories
- how far these factors contributed to the Palestinian *Intifada* from 1987, i.e. Israeli policy leading to Palestinian violence (pages 87–8).

On the period after 1993 (Chapter 6) you need to explain:

- conflicting Israeli and Palestinian views of the Oslo Accords (page 97)
- continued Israeli settlement building, especially on the West Bank
- suicide bombings by Palestinians
- the second *Intifada* and the Israeli response.

Throughout the essay you should try to identify the causal links between Israeli policy and Palestinian terrorism (and vice versa) as part of your assessment of whether Palestinian terrorism was the chief obstacle to peace. In conclusion, you need to weigh up the importance of Palestinian terrorism in the context of other obstacles to permanent peace and, finally, make your judgement about whether it was the *main* factor.